



Social Psychology (SOCPSY)

Module 3: Social Perception

Impressions, Stereotypes and Bias

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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Impression Formation

We form impressions quickly. The primacy effect means first information weighs heavily. Central traits, such as warm versus cold, organise many other judgments. In a job interview or first tutorial, early moments often shape the overall rating.

Stereotypes, Prejudice, and Discrimination

A stereotype is a cognitive generalisation about a group. Prejudice is an attitude, often negative, toward a group based on membership. Discrimination is behaviour that treats people differently because of group membership. They are related but not the same.

Reducing Bias in Daily Life

Slow down before judging a person from one act. Ask what situational factors might apply. Seek individual information, not only group labels. In group work, assign roles fairly and make contribution visible where possible.

Reflect: Which step would help most in a judgment you made recently: slow down, consider situation, or seek individual information?

Closing

Module 3 covered attribution, impressions, and intergroup bias. Module 4 turns to individuals and groups.